fish—all this within a fifty-six day period. It was still a risky activity as illustrated by a story from the same year.

On a hunt in 1610 in Bari near Agra, one of Emperor Jehangir's courtiers, Anup Rai, came across a half-devoured cow and traced a lion in the thicket. The animal was surrounded and the emperor was informed. Jehangir rushed to the spot and set up his musket on a stand. He fired twice and missed. The lion charged and the emperor's retinue bolted and, according to him, even trampled on him in the panic! Anup Rai saved Jehangir's life by battling the lion to the ground with his bare hands till Prince Khurram killed the animal with a sword. That a Hindu Rajput was not just accompanying the royal family on a hunt but was willing to risk his life for a Muslim king—Taimur's direct descendant, no less—shows how the relations between Hindus and Muslims had evolved over the preceding half-century. Jehangir gave Anup Rai the title Ani Rai Singhdalan, meaning Commander of Troops and Lion Crusher. [31]

A few years after the above events, the first English ambassador arrived at the Mughal court. Sir Thomas Roe was a distinguished diplomat and was in India from 1615 to 1619. He became a close friend of Emperor Jehangir and was even his drinking partner on several occasions. However, this does not mean that he was given blanket permission to freely kill lions. In 1617, a lion and a wolf made nightly raids on Roe's camp near Mandu and killed a number of his sheep and goats. However, it was forbidden for him to hurt the animals and had to send for the monarch's special leave. It was eventually granted but the lion escaped. The wolf was not so lucky. [32]

Roe tells us that the lion was a very important part of royal imagery and one of the royal standards had a lion and the rising sun. This symbolism was shared with both the Shahs of Iran as well as the indigenous Hindu tradition. The Mughals were conscious that they were inheritors of an ancient imperial dream and Emperor Jehangir inserted his own inscription in Persian on the Mauryan pillar in Allahabad. Thus, the column has inscriptions by three of India's most powerful emperors—Ashoka, Samudragupta and Jehangir—a continuity maintained over eighteen